

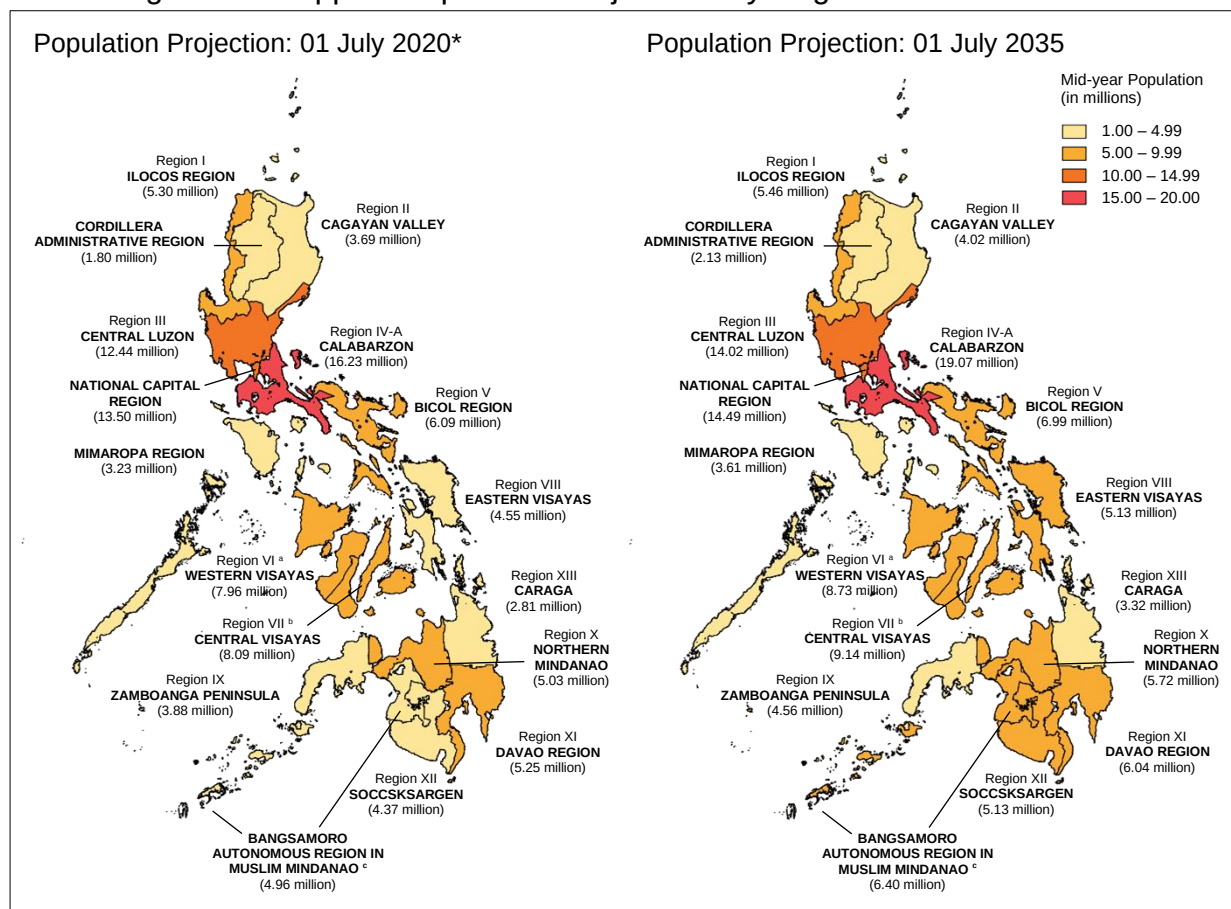
PRESS RELEASE

CALABARZON to Retain Top Spot as Most Populous Region Until 2035

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This report presents the highlights of the 2020 Census-Based Regional, Provincial/Highly Urbanized City (HUC), and City/Municipality Level Population Projections. These subnational population projections were prepared by the Philippine Statistics Authority (PSA) in collaboration with the Inter-Agency Working Group on Population Projections, with technical assistance from the United Nations Population Fund Philippines.

Figure 1. Philippine Population Projections by Region: 2020 and 2035



* The 2020 Census of Population and Housing counts for each region, as of 01 May 2020, were adjusted to the mid-year population as of 01 July 2020, using a growth rate value derived for each region from number of registered deaths, age specific fertility rates, and net migrants for 2020. The mid-year population allows for consistent comparison between years.

^a Includes the Province of Negros Occidental and City of Bacolod

^b Includes the Provinces of Negros Oriental and Siquijor

^c Includes the Province of Sulu

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, 2020 Census-Based Population Projections

The Philippine mid-year population is projected to reach 123.96 million by 2035. In a span of 15 years, around 14.76 million people will be added to the country's total population of 109.20 million in 2020. The average annual growth rate for the period 2020 to 2035 is estimated at 0.85 percent. By 2035, the male population is expected to reach around 62.64 million (50.5% share), while the female population will be about 61.32 million (49.5% share), resulting in a sex ratio of 102 males for every 100 females. (Table 1)

The CALABARZON region is projected to remain the most populous region in 2035, with an estimated population of 19.07 million. It is followed by the National Capital Region (NCR) and Central Luzon, with projected populations of 14.49 million and 14.02 million, respectively. Meanwhile, the Cordillera Administrative Region (CAR) is expected to have the smallest population in 2035, with a projected population of 2.13 million. (Figure 1)

As of the 2020 mid-year population, nine regions had already reached the five million mark. By 2035, this number is anticipated to rise to 12 regions with the addition of Eastern Visayas, SOCCSKSARGEN, and Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM). (Figure 1)

In terms of population distribution by sex, most regions in the Philippines are expected to have more males than females by 2035, except for NCR and BARMM. In NCR, females are projected to slightly outnumber males in 2035, with 7.29 million females compared to 7.20 million males, resulting in a sex ratio of about 99 males per 100 females. In BARMM, the sex ratio is almost in equilibrium in 2035, with 3.201 million females and 3.196 million males, leading to a sex ratio of approximately 100 males per 100 females. (Table 1)

Table 1. Projected Philippine Population by Sex and Region
and Sex Ratio by Region: 2035

Region ^a	Mid-Year Population Projections (in millions)			Sex Ratio
	Both Sexes	Male	Female	
Philippines	123.96	62.64	61.32	102
National Capital Region (NCR)	14.49	7.20	7.29	99
Cordillera Administrative Region (CAR)	2.13	1.08	1.04	104
Region I (Ilocos Region)	5.46	2.77	2.70	103
Region II (Cagayan Valley)	4.02	2.04	1.98	103
Region III (Central Luzon)	14.02	7.08	6.94	102
Region IV-A (CALABARZON)	19.07	9.58	9.49	101
MIMAROPA Region	3.61	1.84	1.77	104
Region V (Bicol Region)	6.99	3.54	3.45	103
Region VI (Western Visayas)	8.73	4.44	4.29	103
Region VII (Central Visayas)	9.14	4.64	4.51	103
Region VIII (Eastern Visayas)	5.13	2.63	2.50	105
Region IX (Zamboanga Peninsula)	4.56	2.31	2.25	103
Region X (Northern Mindanao)	5.72	2.92	2.80	104

Region ^a	Mid-Year Population Projections (in millions)			Sex Ratio
	Both Sexes	Male	Female	
Region XI (Davao Region)	6.04	3.08	2.96	104
Region XII (SOCCSKSARGEN)	5.13	2.61	2.52	104
Region XIII (Caraga)	3.32	1.70	1.62	105
Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM) ^b	6.40	3.196	3.201	100

^a The Negros Island Region has not yet been established as a separate region at the time the 2020 Census-Based Population Projections inputs were prepared. Its provinces and highly urbanized city were assessed under their respective regions at that time. The Province of Negros Occidental and the City of Bacolod were part of Region VI, while the Provinces of Negros Oriental and Siquijor were included in Region VII.

^b Includes the Province of Sulu

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, 2020 Census-Based Population Projections

Certain regions are anticipated to see a steady increase in their population growth rates over this period. This includes Bicol Region, Western Visayas, Eastern Visayas, Zamboanga Peninsula, SOCCSKSARGEN, BARMM, and Caraga. BARMM is expected to experience a notable rise, with its average annual growth rate increasing from 1.62 percent during the 2020 to 2025 period to 1.79 percent in the 2030 to 2035 period, reflecting robust population growth. (Table 2)

On the other hand, several regions are projected to experience a continued decline in their growth rates. NCR, Cagayan Valley, Central Luzon, CALABARZON, and Northern Mindanao are all expected to see a decrease in average annual population growth over time. For instance, NCR's average annual growth rate is projected to drop from 0.53 percent in the 2020 to 2025 period to 0.40 percent in the 2030 to 2035 period, indicating a slowdown in the average annual population growth in the region. (Table 2)

Additionally, regions like CAR, Ilocos Region, MIMAROPA, Central Visayas and Davao Region are expected to experience fluctuating growth rates, with minor increases or decreases in each five-year interval. For example, CAR's average annual growth rate fluctuates from 1.10 percent in 2020 to 2025 to 1.15 percent in 2025 to 2030, before declining to 1.09 percent in the 2030 to 2035 period. (Table 2)

Table 2. Average Annual Population Growth Rates by Region and Five-Year Interval: 2020-2035

Region ^a	Average Annual Population Growth Rate (in percent)		
	2020-2025	2025-2030	2030-2035
Philippines	0.84	0.86	0.84
National Capital Region (NCR)	0.53	0.49	0.40
Cordillera Administrative Region (CAR)	1.10	1.15	1.09
Region I (Ilocos Region)	0.20	0.22	0.17
Region II (Cagayan Valley)	0.65	0.59	0.49
Region III (Central Luzon)	0.84	0.81	0.75
Region IV-A (CALABARZON)	1.17	1.09	0.98
MIMAROPA Region	0.73	0.76	0.74

Region ^a	Average Annual Population Growth Rate (in percent)		
	2020-2025	2025-2030	2030-2035
Region V (Bicol Region)	0.79	0.94	1.04
Region VI (Western Visayas)	0.53	0.64	0.68
Region VII (Central Visayas)	0.79	0.83	0.82
Region VIII (Eastern Visayas)	0.66	0.83	0.92
Region IX (Zamboanga Peninsula)	0.99	1.09	1.13
Region X (Northern Mindanao)	0.88	0.87	0.82
Region XI (Davao Region)	0.94	0.95	0.92
Region XII (SOCCSKSARGEN)	1.03	1.09	1.10
Region XIII (Caraga)	1.00	1.14	1.21
Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM) ^b	1.62	1.71	1.79

^a The Negros Island Region has not yet been established as a separate region at the time the 2020 Census-Based Population Projections inputs were prepared. Its provinces and highly urbanized city were assessed under their respective regions at that time. The Province of Negros Occidental and the City of Bacolod were part of Region VI, while the Provinces of Negros Oriental and Siquijor were included in Region VII.

^b Includes the Province of Sulu

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, 2020 Census-Based Population Projections

Provincial/HUC Population Projections

In 2020, Cavite had the largest population among all provinces, with 4.36 million people, followed by Bulacan with 3.72 million, and Laguna with 3.39 million. By 2030, Cavite is projected to remain as the most populous province, with a population of 5.30 million, followed again by Bulacan with 4.17 million. However, Rizal is expected to surpass Laguna in 2030 to become the third most populous province, with 3.88 million people compared to the projected population of Laguna of about 3.72 million. (Table 3)

Table 3. Provinces that are Expected to Have Three Million and Above Population: 2030

Rank	Province	Population Projections (in thousands)		
		01 July 2020*	01 July 2025	01 July 2030
1	Cavite	4,360.50	4,823.00	5,303.60
2	Bulacan	3,716.80	3,939.30	4,168.00
3	Rizal	3,339.60	3,609.60	3,881.30
4	Cebu**	3,333.70	3,574.00	3,833.00
5	Laguna	3,388.70	3,561.70	3,724.60
6	Pangasinan	3,165.70	3,227.30	3,293.20
7	Batangas	2,912.30	3,007.50	3,089.70

* The 2020 Census of Population and Housing counts for each region, as of 01 May 2020, were adjusted to the mid-year population as of 01 July 2020, using a growth rate value derived for each region from number of registered deaths, age specific fertility rates, and net migrants for 2020. The mid-year population allows for consistent comparison between years.

** Excluding the population of HUCs

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, 2020 Census-Based Population Projections

Population projections for HUCs in the Philippines indicate that Quezon City will remain the largest in 2030 with a population of 2.92 million, a decrease from 2.96 million population in 2020. It will be followed by the City of Davao, which is expected to grow from 1.78 million in 2020 to 2.04 million by 2030. The population of the City of Manila is expected to reach 1.90 million in 2030, while the City of Caloocan is expected to increase to 1.71 million. The City of Taguig is projected to grow, reaching 1.52 million in 2030, and the City of Zamboanga is expected to surpass one million by 2030, reaching 1.15 million. (Table 4)

Table 4. HUCs that are Expected to Have One Million and Above Population: 2030

Rank	Highly Urbanized City	Population Projections (in thousands)		
		01 July 2020*	01 July 2025	01 July 2030
1	Quezon City	2,960.00	2,944.30	2,918.60
2	City of Davao	1,781.30	1,906.40	2,040.20
3	City of Manila	1,847.70	1,877.40	1,901.50
4	City of Caloocan	1,662.60	1,687.80	1,707.90
5	City of Taguig	1,228.10	1,367.40	1,516.30
6	City of Zamboanga	980.00	1,061.00	1,153.10

* The 2020 Census of Population and Housing counts for each region, as of 01 May 2020, were adjusted to the mid-year population as of 01 July 2020, using a growth rate value derived for each region from number of registered deaths, age specific fertility rates, and net migrants for 2020. The mid-year population allows for consistent comparison between years.

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, 2020 Census-Based Population Projections

By 2030, 55 provinces and 11 HUCs in the Philippines are anticipated to exceed the national average sex ratio, reflecting a greater number of males per 100 females in these areas. (Tables 5 and 6)

Batanes is projected to have the highest sex ratio, with 114 males for every 100 females. Other provinces with higher sex ratio than the national average include Ifugao, Palawan, Quirino, Mountain Province, Eastern Samar, Bukidnon, and Nueva Vizcaya, each estimated at 108 males per 100 females. Agusan del Sur, Sarangani, Occidental Mindoro, and Benguet are expected to follow with a sex ratio of 107 males per 100 females. Additionally, provinces of Davao de Oro (Compostela Valley), Apayao, Davao Occidental, Surigao del Sur, and Samar (Western Samar) are projected to have a sex ratio of 106 males per 100 females. There are 38 other provinces that are anticipated to exceed the national average in 2030, with sex ratios varying from 105 males (in 5 provinces), 104 males (in 15 provinces), and 103 males (in 18 provinces), for every 100 females. (Table 5)

Table 5. Provinces that are Expected to Exceed the National Average Sex Ratio: 2030

Number of Provinces	Provinces	2030 Sex Ratio (males per 100 females)
	Philippines	102
1	Batanes	114
7	Ifugao, Palawan, Quirino, Mountain Province, Eastern Samar, Bukidnon, and Nueva Vizcaya	108

Number of Provinces	Provinces	2030 Sex Ratio (males per 100 females)
4	Agusan del Sur, Sarangani, Occidental Mindoro, and Benguet	107
5	Davao de Oro (Compostela Valley), Apayao, Davao Occidental, Surigao del Sur, and Samar (Western Samar)	106
5	Northern Samar, Kalinga, Catanduanes, Dinagat Islands, and Leyte	105
15	Misamis Oriental, Aklan, Iloilo, Agusan del Norte, Surigao del Norte, Guimaras, Antique, Sultan Kudarat, Davao Oriental, Sorsogon, Zamboanga del Norte, Biliran, Capiz, Davao del Norte, and Cotabato (North Cotabato)	104
18	South Cotabato, Negros Occidental, Davao del Sur, Pangasinan, Cebu, Bohol, Camarines Norte, Pampanga, Zamboanga del Sur, Bulacan, Southern Leyte, Isabela, Tarlac, Aurora, Camarines Sur, Albay, Masbate, and Zamboanga Sibugay	103

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, 2020 Census-Based Population Projections

As for HUCs, the City of Mandaue is expected to record the highest sex ratio of 108 males per 100 females by 2030. Following closely are the cities of Tacloban (Capital), Muntinlupa, Cagayan de Oro (Capital), and Davao, along with the City of Lapu-Lapu (Opon), each projected to have sex ratios of 104 or higher. Furthermore, cities like San Juan, General Santos (Dadiangas), Isabela (Capital), Valenzuela, and Butuan are expected to achieve a sex ratio of 103, also exceeding the national average of 102 males per 100 females. (Table 6)

Table 6. HUCs that are Expected to Exceed the National Average Sex Ratio: 2030

Highly Urbanized City	Sex Ratio (males per 100 females)
City of Mandaue	108
City of Tacloban (Capital)	106
City of Muntinlupa	104
City of Cagayan de Oro (Capital)	104
City of Davao	104
City of Lapu-Lapu (Opon)	104
City of San Juan	103
City of General Santos (Dadiangas)	103
City of Isabela (Capital)	103
City of Valenzuela	103
City of Butuan (Capital)	103

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, 2020 Census-Based Population Projections

City/Municipality Population Projections

By 2030, the City of Antipolo in Rizal is projected to have the highest population among the cities, reaching approximately 986.80 thousand, followed by the City of San Jose Del Monte in Bulacan with 801.50 thousand. The cities of Dasmariñas, Bacoor, and Imus in Cavite are expected to have populations of 719.00 thousand, 716.70 thousand, and 697.90 thousand, respectively. (Table 7)

Table 7. Top Five Cities with the Highest Population by 2030

Rank	City	Province	Population Projections (in thousands)		
			01 July 2020*	01 July 2025	01 July 2030
1	City of Antipolo	Rizal	889.50	941.50	986.80
2	City of San Jose Del Monte	Bulacan	654.40	727.80	801.50
3	City of Dasmariñas	Cavite	703.80	716.10	719.00
4	City of Bacoor	Cavite	665.80	695.20	716.70
5	City of Imus	Cavite	499.80	594.70	697.90

* The 2020 Census of Population and Housing counts for each region, as of 01 May 2020, were adjusted to the mid-year population as of 01 July 2020, using a growth rate value derived for each region from number of registered deaths, age specific fertility rates, and net migrants for 2020. The mid-year population allows for consistent comparison between years.

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, 2020 Census-Based Population Projections

Among the municipalities, Rodriguez (Montalban) in Rizal is projected to lead with a population of 592.50 thousand by 2030. Taytay in Rizal follows with an estimated population of 440.70 thousand. Tanza (431.60 thousand) in Cavite, Cainta (395.50 thousand) in Rizal, and Silang (342.90 thousand) in Cavite round out the top five municipalities with the highest population by 2030. (Table 8)

Table 8. Top Five Municipalities with the Highest Population by 2030

Rank	Municipality	Province	Population Projections (in thousands)		
			01 July 2020*	01 July 2025	01 July 2030
1	Rodriguez (Montalban)	Rizal	446.40	517.40	592.50
2	Taytay	Rizal	387.50	415.50	440.70
3	Tanza	Cavite	314.00	370.80	431.60
4	Cainta	Rizal	377.30	388.40	395.50
5	Silang	Cavite	296.60	320.80	342.90

* The 2020 Census of Population and Housing counts for each region, as of 01 May 2020, were adjusted to the mid-year population as of 01 July 2020, using a growth rate value derived for each region from number of registered deaths, age specific fertility rates, and net migrants for 2020. The mid-year population allows for consistent comparison between years.

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, 2020 Census-Based Population Projections

The PSA Board has approved the methodologies used in generating the 2020 Census-Based Regional, Provincial/HUC, and City/Municipality Level of Population Projections and their adoption by all concerned agencies through PSA Board Resolution No. 18, Series of 2024, dated 15 November 2024.



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